

Unit 4 — Teacher How-to-Use & MTSS Guide

The Executive Branch · Course Standard · GC.16-GC.18 · Grades 9-12

Release-Ready · Pilot Edition. This guide holds the answer key for teacher use only — keep it separate from student materials.

1. Firm Goals, Flexible Means

One firm learning goal per standard; flexible, universal means. Supports are available by design and never lower the goal. They work alongside — never in place of — required IEP or 504 accommodations.

The same six labels students see

Label	Meaning
CORE PATH	Essential instruction every student completes.
SUPPORT OPTION	Optional scaffold that keeps the goal, not lowers it.
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, and Spanish cognates.
RESPONSE CHOICE	Write, say/record, or diagram.
PROGRESS CHECK	Quick DOK-2/3 check to guide reteach or extend.
EXTENSION	Deeper challenge once the goal is met.

2. Label-to-Action Table

When you see...	Do this
CORE PATH	Teach to all; this is the standard expectation.
SUPPORT OPTION / Guided Back	Offer to any student; never assign by track.
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Pre-teach Word Bank terms; use Spanish column for access.
PROGRESS CHECK	Collect a quick response; route with the Decision Cycle.
EXTENSION	Offer the higher-DOK CER/Extension Bank to anyone ready.

3. MTSS — Tiers of Support Intensity

Tier	Who / when	In this unit
Tier 1 (Core)	All students	Full deck + workbook CORE PATH, Word Bank, Cornell Notes.
Tier 2 (Targeted)	Students missing a Progress Check	Guided Support Back, sentence frames, Rehearsal Lab.
Tier 3 (Intensive)	Persistent barrier	Pair Guided Back with IEP/504 supports; reteach a step.

4. The MTSS Decision Cycle

PROGRESS CHECK → identify barrier → select support → reteach → recheck → extend

Scaffold fading

Fade Guided → Light → independent as evidence grows; reintroduce support for a new barrier. Required IEP/504 accommodations do not fade unless the authorized team changes them.

5. District Review Evidence Snapshot

Criterion	Where it shows
Standards alignment (GC.16–GC.18)	Standards & SSP Crosswalk; per-standard blocks.
Public-domain sources, cited	Source Library; Activity 5 each standard.
UDL 3.0 visible	Accessibility matrix; callouts throughout.
MTSS	This guide §3–4; wrap-up decision band in the Teacher Deck.
Assessment integrity	Answer key here (separate); de-biased positions.

6. Direct Teaching + Cornell Notes + Slide Deck Workflow

Project the Student (Lean) Deck; students take Cornell Notes on the Universal Front. The Teacher (Full) Deck carries Quick Reviews, Guided Practice, Checks for Understanding, and Answer Reveals.

Verified Lean Student Deck ranges (from the final 64-slide deck)

Standard	Lean Deck range	Direct-teaching	Vocab	Primary source	Progress Check
GC.16	2–8	4–6	3	7	8
GC.17	2–8	4–6	3	7	8
GC.18	2–8	4–6	3	7	8

7. What to Print and When

Print	When
Cornell Universal Front (per standard)	Day 1 of each standard.
Guided / Light Support Backs	On request only; reverse of the front.
Practice Quiz + CER	After direct teaching, before the standard assessment.
Source Library	Once per unit for reference.

8. Per-Standard Lesson Sequence & Pacing (one standard = one 45-minute period)

Each standard is taught in a single 45-minute period, but the workbook intentionally holds more activity than one period can fit — run them all and it is roughly 90–105

minutes. That is by design: you choose which activities fill your period, and the rest become bell-ringers, stations, homework, reteach, or extension. The estimates below are honest time-on-task for an average class; adjust for yours. Every workbook activity header shows the same ⌚ estimate so students can self-pace.

Honest activity time estimates (pick what fills your 45 minutes)

Activity	~Time	Note
Standard launch (hook · goal · activate · predict)	5 min	Frames the learning target and the day.
Activity 1 — Vocabulary Word Bank	10 min	Reference + self-check + quick-write.
Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer)	7 min	One priority term, four quadrants.
Activity 3 — Cornell Notes (with slide deck)	20 min	Direct-teaching capture — front + processing back.
Activity 4 — Close Read	15 min	Passage, annotation, text-dependent questions.
Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data (HIPPO)	15 min	Source + five HIPPO prompts + response.
Activity 6 — Practice Quiz	8 min	A few items + one short DOK-3 write.
Activity 7 — CER + Exit Ticket	15 min	CER organizer + paragraph (~12) and Exit Ticket (~3).

Run every activity and a standard totals ≈ 105 minutes (≈ 95 without a map) — about two periods of work compressed into a one-period design. So it is a menu, not a checklist.

How to fill the period — your call

You decide which activities run in class. A common choice is Launch → Cornell Notes with the deck → one analysis activity (Close Read or Primary Source) → the Exit Ticket, but nothing forces that set — pick what your class needs that day.

The Exit Ticket is the daily formative check; try to close every period with it (see §16 for the keys and reteach routing).

Whatever you do not run in class becomes a bell-ringer, station, early-finisher task, homework, reteach, or extension. Rigor stays the same for every learner; UDL/MTSS supports layer on without lowering the bar.

9. Assessment Source & Item Metadata

Each standard's Progress Check / Transfer Check is a Teacher-Deck Check for Understanding (DOK 2-3). The additional Practice-Quiz DOK-1 items are Government Hack-authored recall items. All items are pre-field-test (classroom-formative), not a secure TCAP form. Correct-answer positions are de-biased and identical across Student Progress Check, Teacher CFU/Reveal, and the workbook Transfer Check.

De-biased key distribution (Transfer Checks, GC.16-GC.18)

C · B · D

10. Practice Quiz — Answer Key & Rationales

For teacher use only — keep separate from student copies.

GC.16 — Article II & the Presidency

Item	DOK	Key	Rationale
u4-gc16-dok1-1	1	B	Recall of the standard's core term/fact.
u1-gc16-dok2-tc	2	C	DOK 2: Article II gives the President power to make treaties and appointments only 'by and with the Advice and Consent of the Senate' — a legislative check on executive power.

GC.17 — Departments of the Executive Branch

Item	DOK	Key	Rationale
u4-gc17-dok1-1	1	A	Recall of the standard's core term/fact.
u1-gc17-dok2-tc	2	B	DOK 2: The Department of State manages diplomacy and foreign relations; Treasury handles money, Defense the military, Justice the law, and Education federal school policy.

GC.18 — The Electoral College

Item	DOK	Key	Rationale
u4-gc18-dok1-1	1	B	Recall of the standard's core term/fact.
u1-gc18-dok3-tc	3	D	DOK 3: The winner is decided by electoral votes, not the national popular vote; because most states use winner-take-all, a candidate can gather more electoral votes while another wins more total votes nationwide.

11. How CAST UDL 3.0 Is Visible in Unit 1

UDL principle	In this unit
Engagement	Response choice; Tennessee Connection relevance; optional extensions.
Representation	Word Bank + pronunciation + Spanish; Close-Read supports; HIPPO scaffold.
Action & Expression	Write / say / diagram; Frayer studio; CER with rubric.

No fixed-track labels appear anywhere in the student materials; supports are universal and optional.

12. Printable Blank Templates

Reusable blank versions of the two most-printed student pages — print as many as you need for any lesson. Each is designed to fill one page; the Cornell notes are meant to print duplex with a support scaffold on the reverse.

Blank Cornell Notes — Universal Front (printable)

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____ Topic: _____

LEARNING TARGET	
I can _____	
Guiding cues (about 25%)	My notes (about 75%)

The 25/75 split describes the approximate width of each writing column (label, not a fixed track).

Key terms to list
Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)
My 12-15 word headline

Print duplex: the Guided or Light Support for these notes goes on the reverse of this page.

Blank Vocabulary Studio — Frayer (printable)

RESPONSE CHOICE

Complete the studio by writing, speaking, or diagramming.

PRIORITY TERM _____

ES: _____

Word-bank meaning to build on: _____

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples
Use it to explain — write one sentence that uses the term	

13. Social Studies Practices (SSP) Crosswalk

Each activity in the seven-activity cycle builds specific Tennessee Social Studies Practices. Every SSP.01–SSP.06 is covered within each standard’s cycle.

Activity	Builds	Practice
Cornell Notes (Activity 3)	SSP.05	Develop historical awareness — sequence events, recognize cause & effect.
Close Read (Activity 4)	SSP.03 · SSP.05	Synthesize data from multiple sources; historical awareness.
Primary Source / HIPPO (Activity 5)	SSP.01 · SSP.02	Gather, analyze, and evaluate sources; critically examine a source for point of view, bias, context.
Geographer’s Lens (G-tagged standards)	SSP.06	Analyze relationships among geography, economics, and society across time and place.
Practice Quiz (Activity 6)	SSP.01–06 (assessed)	Applied across items.
CER (Activity 7)	SSP.04	Construct and communicate arguments citing supporting evidence.
Coverage All six practices (SSP.01–SSP.06) are built within every standard’s cycle.		

14. Standard Dimension Coverage (C · E · G · H · P · T · TCA)

Each TN standard carries dimension tags. This crosswalk shows where each dimension is taught within the standard — evidence of full coverage for adoption review. Students see these as plain-language “lenses” on each standard’s opening page.

GC.16 — Article II & the Presidency

Dimension	Where it is taught in this standard
History (H)	How the presidency's powers and limits have been tested across American history.

GC.17 — Departments of the Executive Branch

Dimension	Where it is taught in this standard
Politics/Government (P)	How the executive branch is organized to carry out the law at scale.

GC.18 — The Electoral College

Dimension	Where it is taught in this standard
Geography (G)	How electoral votes map onto states and 'swing states' shape campaigns.
History (H)	How the Electoral College has produced popular-vote/electoral-vote splits over time.

15. Constructed Response (CER) — 6-Point Rubric

The course's canonical constructed-response scale. Student materials use the simple Full / Developing / Beginning per part; teachers score with the 6-point guide below (aligns with the DBQ/CER rubric bank).

Score	Level	What it looks like
6	Exemplary	Defensible, insightful claim; TWO or more precise, accurate pieces of evidence; reasoning fully explains HOW the evidence proves the claim; cohesive and sophisticated.
5	Advanced	Clear claim; strong, accurate evidence; reasoning explains the link with only minor gaps.
4	Proficient	Adequate claim; some specific evidence; reasoning present but general.
3	Adequate	Basic claim; limited or partly accurate evidence; reasoning thin.
2	Developing	Vague claim; little evidence; evidence largely unexplained.
1	Beginning	No clear claim; little or no evidence; no reasoning.

Swap in your bank's exact CER rubric text if it differs; the 6-point scale (6 Exemplary → 1 Beginning) is the course convention.

16. Exit Ticket Answer Keys + What's Next (reteach)

For teacher use only — keep separate from student copies. Each standard's Exit Ticket (end of the standard, on the CER page) with its key and reteach routing. Items are pre-field-test.

Std	Item	DOK	Key	What's Next if a student misses it
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